

React Beginner Guide – Step by Step

This guide is **for complete beginners**. You will learn: - What React is - How to install React - Folder structure explanation - How to run the project - Create a sample page - See output

1 What is React?

React is a **JavaScript library** used to build **websites and web applications UI**.

✔ Used for: - Single Page Applications (SPA) - Fast UI updates - Component-based development

Examples of React websites: - Facebook - Instagram - Netflix

2 Requirements (Install First)

Before React, install these:

✔ 1. Install Node.js

- Download from: <https://nodejs.org>
- Install **LTS version**

Check installation:

```
node -v  
npm -v
```

3 Create React App (Using Vite – Easy & Fast)

Step 1: Create project folder

Open **Command Prompt / Terminal**:

```
npm create vite@latest my-react-app
```

Step 2: Select options

Choose: - Framework → **React** - Variant → **JavaScript**

Step 3: Go to project folder

`cd my-react-app`

Step 4: Install dependencies

`npm install`

4 Run React Project

`npm run dev`

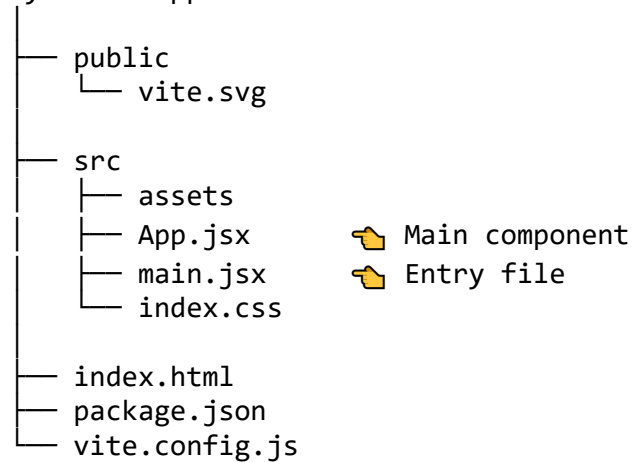
You will see:

Local: <http://localhost:5173/>

Open browser → paste URL 🍌

5 React Folder Structure (Important)

my-react-app



Key Files

- **main.jsx** → React starts here
 - **App.jsx** → Main UI
 - **index.html** → Root HTML file
-

6 How React Works (Simple Flow)

`index.html` → `main.jsx` → `App.jsx` → Browser

7 Create Your First Page (Example)

 Edit src/App.jsx

```
function App() {  
  return (  
    <div>  
      <h1>Welcome to My First React Website</h1>  
      <p>This is created using React</p>  
      <button>Click Me</button>  
    </div>  
  );  
}
```

export default App;

Save file → Browser auto refresh 

8 Output (What You Will See)

Welcome to My First React Website
This is created using React
[Click Me]

9 Create a Component (Recommended Way)

 Create new folder

src/components

 Create file Hello.jsx

```
function Hello() {  
  return <h2>Hello Component Works!</h2>;  
}
```

export default Hello;

 Use component in App.jsx

import Hello **from** "../components/Hello";

```
function App() {  
  return (  
    <div>  
      <h1>Main App</h1>  
      <Hello />  
    </div>  
  );  
}
```

```
    </div>
  );
}

export default App;
```

10 JSX Explanation (Very Important)

```
<h1>Hello</h1>
```

✓ This is **JSX** (HTML inside JavaScript)

Rules: - Must return **one parent element** - Use `className` instead of `class`

1 1 Basic CSS Example

 Edit `src/index.css`

```
body {
  font-family: Arial;
  background: #f4f4f4;
}

h1 {
  color: blue;
}
```

1 2 Common Commands

```
npm run dev      # Start project
npm install      # Install packages
npm run build    # Production build
```

1 3 Beginner Learning Path

1. JSX
2. Components
3. Props
4. `useState`
5. Events
6. Forms

7. API calls
